

Purge and Fortify Your Soul

Over the last couple of services, and really over this last month, the Holy Ghost has been pulling me aside so we could examine the progression into sin and the reversing of that process to come back out. We found out what got us in so we could find out what gets us out.

It all starts with uncaptured thoughts. Those become high things that exalt themselves against the knowledge of God with the intention of replacing His knowledge. Then they become imaginations.

James reverses the whole process. He says every man who falls into sin is tempted, tested, or tried when he is drawn away by his own lust and enticed. When lust conceives and comes alive in a man's bosom, it brings forth sin, and sin brings forth death.

Then, in warning us to reverse the process, he says we need to put away all filthiness and superfluity of naughtiness, and receive the engrafted Word of God, which is able to save our souls.

Whenever the devil wants to indoctrinate a decade or generation into the breakup of morals, Christian families, divorce, and sin, Satan hands a mandate down to his principalities. It goes something like this: "Take all the unclean spirits at your disposal and unleash them on the entire body of Christ at once, for I want the fruit of this to manifest in a decade."

These principalities issue orders to powers. The powers disperse it to the rulers of darkness placed over different regions, and they disperse it to the untold millions of unclean spirits who go about the task of causing these things to come to pass.

Suddenly there are waves of immorality, divorce, illicit affairs, scandals, and money problems. It seems to come in waves, as though somebody masterminded it. They did.

We think of demon possession as some slobbering person stalking children, someone who does not know how to dress himself in the morning. But there are demon-possessed people who border on genius. They are tremendous personalities. When powers or principalities come to them, they manipulate their lives until they are in key positions behind media, educational systems, entertainment, literature, newspapers, and anything that affects the way you think.

Superfluity of naughtiness is when you and I let ourselves go beyond acceptable limitations and give ourselves to things we know violate our morals and are not acceptable. It begins the process of uncaptured thoughts that turn into high things exalting themselves against the knowledge of God, and then into imaginations.

An imagination is a way a man thinks, overpowered by emotion, with no basis in truth.

James says every man is tempted, tested, or tried. Temptations are thrown at everybody. A man yields to temptation when he is enticed and drawn away by his own lust through superfluity of naughtiness. He keeps lending himself to the temptation until it catches hold. Then he falls into immorality, pornography, divorce, scandal, or some other sin.

You may think it happened overnight. It did not. It was a plan as well laid and executed as the divine order Jesus Christ placed in the body of Christ through apostles, prophets, and teachers for the maturity of the body. Satan is organized. He is not stupid.

When he issues orders and carries them out through different classes of wicked spirits, suddenly a whole generation opens itself to unclean spirits through media, programming, and everything that takes people a step further into uncaptured thoughts. Those thoughts become high things that exalt themselves against the knowledge of God, and finally end in lust that conceives and brings forth sin.

If we know what got us in, then we should understand what gets us out.

James opens this clearly in the first chapter:

Let no man say when he is tempted, I am tempted of God: for God cannot be tempted with evil, neither tempteth he any man:

But every man is tempted, when he is drawn away of his own lust, and enticed.

Then when lust hath conceived, it bringeth forth sin: and sin, when it is finished, bringeth forth death.

When lust conceives, it comes alive like a germinated seed. It gets hold of a man's soul, takes root, and controls his emotions. Lust conceives, its child is sin, and sin will kill you quicker than a snake.

James then talks about reversing the process. He assures us that every good and perfect gift comes down from the Father of lights, with whom there is no variableness or shadow of turning. God is so constant that there is no movement in Him away from good. If every good and perfect gift comes down, then it comes down from the Father of lights.

Therefore, put away from yourself all superfluity of naughtiness, and receive the engrafted Word of God, which is able to save and stabilize your soul.

The man who looks into the perfect law of liberty and then walks away is like someone looking in a mirror and forgetting what he looks like. He looked into the perfect law of liberty but forgot what was written there, so it is impossible for him to conform to it. But the one who looks into the perfect law of liberty and continues in it becomes blessed in his deeds.

The engrafted Word of God is able to stabilize your soul against the superfluity of naughtiness that turns into temptation, enticement, lust, sin, and death.

If uncaptured thoughts get me into the problem, then millions of God's thoughts flowing through me will get me out.

I have been counseling many preachers lately who have fallen into sin. Some of their testimonies would scare you.

Some say, "Brother Roberson, I am not at the place where I mostly want to quit. If you ask me whether I want to quit sinning, I do not want to. I want to want to, but I do not want to. Can you pray for me and make me want to quit?"

Their emotions are exhausted. The devil has trapped them, and it is a mess. Some have been in ministry for years. Some have fallen publicly. Some are carrying a double standard, what we would label as hypocrisy, because they stand behind the pulpit and carry on their duties while living that double standard.

Many good moral family men have fallen to that same system. They are pillars in the church, and they cannot tell their family or each other because it would break the hearts of the people who have the most confidence in them. They do not know where to get help.

When I started preaching this, they came to me. The worst thing they say is, "I do not want to get out of it. If somebody could make me want to, I would. But it has such a hold on me that I do not want to."

I ask, "How about praying in tongues?"

"No, I do not feel like doing that."

"How about worshiping God?"

"I do it in church because it is part of my duty."

That is where private worship separates you from public worship. You can put on a show publicly, but who is going to go into your closet, close the door, and lift your hands when your inner life is divided?

"No, I do not want to worship God."

"How about confessing the Word? Walk the floor and confess that you are free."

"I do not feel like it."

To my amazement, most of them are willing to read the Word of God. If I can get you to start reading the Word, just reading it, half an hour in the Old Testament and half an hour in the New, or an hour in the Old and an hour in the New, it will not be very long before you complete the entire Word of God from beginning to end.

Everything God has said to humanity concerning redemption will begin flowing through you in thoughts. If you keep doing it, every six months everything God said to human beings will flow through you again and again. No matter what kind of slimy rock a man crawls out from under, he needs to get the Word out and read it again.

Pretty soon, all these thoughts of God flowing through you will start ordering your emotions, if you willfully submit yourself to the Word of God. Your emotions will be drawn into it. You will start feeling like praying again, worshiping again, confessing again, and coming back.

You do not willfully dismiss emotions. You have to turn them. The beginning process that turns them is thousands and thousands of God's thoughts flowing through you. The whole Bible flowing through you begins to pull the emotions back in and turn them toward a want-to basis with God.

Receive the engrafted Word of God, which is able to save your soul and restore emotional stability.

Let us take this purging process a little further, because we are studying prayer.

If you do not think God will judge this kind of thing, remember that James says lust conceives, brings forth sin, and sin, when it is finished, brings forth death. You are not going to get life out of it.

Go to John 15:

I am the true vine, and my Father is the husbandman.

Every branch in me that beareth not fruit he taketh away:

And every branch that beareth fruit, he purgeth it, that it may bring forth more fruit.

Now ye are clean through the word which I have spoken unto you.

Notice that the branch was in Him. People do not like to talk about these verses too much under certain teachings on grace, but nevertheless, Jesus said every branch in Him that does not bear fruit is taken away. Every branch that bears fruit is purged so it may bring forth more fruit.

Then He says, "Now you are clean," or purged, through the Word He has spoken.

When we lived in Oregon and I first began ministry, we had a Newtown apple tree. Newtowns normally grow apples of decent size, but this tree produced apples about as small as crab apples. The tree needed to be pruned. It had so many limbs that you could not walk under it without snagging your suit and hair.

I asked a neighbor, a farmer type with a chainsaw, if he would prune my apple tree. He said he would. I went away to a meeting and came back. I barely recognized the house. There was a stump. I thought he had killed it.

We waited breathlessly for the first shoots to appear so I would know my poor apple tree survived the pruning. I called him and said, "I think you killed my apple tree."

He said, "You may be right."

I still remember crossing the yard, looking back at that stump. As I put my foot on the first step to go into the house, the Holy Ghost woke up inside me and said, "You have not seen anything yet."

My deepest suspicions came true. He was not talking about the tree. He was talking about me.

Jesus says every branch in Him that refuses to bear fruit will go one way or the other. If you are bearing fruit, you will receive His purging so you can bear more. If you refuse to bear fruit, you will be taken away. It is impossible to ride the line.

A generation or two ago, when our fathers had revival and then compromised one step at a time until they disconnected from the vine, it was not long before they were taken away. We may think not, but it will happen. You will go one way or the other.

If you are bearing fruit, He will purge you so you bear more. He says you are clean and purged through the engrafted Word, through the Word He has spoken.

I want His purging. I just did not know how it worked. If I am purged through the Word of God He has spoken to me, then there must be an involvement of the Holy Spirit. There is.

I am a triune human being, and my purging has to be on three levels. The cry of my heart is not resistance to purging or whether He will do it. The cry of my heart is, "Please do so, Jesus. I do not want to be judged with the world. I do not want, through deception and the cunning craftiness of men who lie in wait to deceive, to be disconnected from the vine and go into eternity like that."

I want the purging if that is what it takes. The question is not whether I will receive it. The question is, "Show me how to yield."

I am tired of religion with wrong methods of praying that take your time and life, and if five years is expended incorrectly, where does that leave you? I am tired of wrong meditating, wrong believing, and wrong standing. I am tired of seeing organizations teach people on a level where, if they contract a terminal disease, they are dead because they have no spiritual stamina to stand.

If these are the things He is purging, then whether you do it or not, God, show us how to walk in it so we can get on with it.

I am a triune human being. I exist on three levels. There is nothing like me in the universe except you. There is only One more unique, and that is God in the essence of His Godhead: Father, Son, and Holy Ghost.

Even angels are not like you. One day the trumpet will sound, you will receive a glorified body, and Jesus is not ashamed to call you His brother. That is the brotherhood of His humanity. As far as His deity is concerned, you will never touch it. He is as much God as He is man, and that is what makes Him more unique than you.

One day I will be a glorified human being occupying a place in eternity with my Father, and I will still exist on three levels: spirit, soul, and glorified flesh. Right now it is spirit, soul, and temptation flesh.

That is why He says:

Walk in the Spirit, and ye shall not fulfil the lust of the flesh.

He did not say, "Walk in the Spirit and all temptations will go away." He said you would be more powerful than they are, so they could not be fulfilled in you.

Have you noticed that if you simply go neutral, you end up sinning? If you sit in the vine and refuse to bear fruit, eventually you are taken away. If you are attempting to bear fruit, He purges you so you will bear more.

With my physical body, I make contact with this physical universe. My body was given so I can contact physical things. When He said to sanctify yourselves wholly, spirit, soul, and body, He meant let sanctification finish its work in the whole person.

My body is a molecular body. It contacts physical matter. I am not going to subject this machine He gave my spirit and soul to live in to things that will harm it if I know what I am doing. Why would I subject it to nicotine, whiskey, and those things? He said to sanctify yourself, spirit, soul, and body.

The soul is your mind, will, intellect, and emotional faculties. James says to receive the engrafted Word of God, which is able to save your souls.

Your soul is a unique part of your operation. It is the social part of your makeup. It was designed to contact other people and make intellectual contact with the creation around you. It has the power to transform itself to what you willfully subject it to.

If someone parachuted you over Alaska, it would not be long before you conformed to your surroundings and survived. That is the power of the soul. It will eventually transform you to what you willfully subject it to: twenty-four hours of Word, or twenty-four hours of television.

Because you willfully subject yourself to it, your soul leads the rest of you into it. That is why emotions cannot be dismissed. They have to be turned. When you willfully decide to walk out of a problem, that is the first decision. Eventually your emotions will turn and follow you out if you subject yourself to the right thing.

Your soul is social. It loves socialization because it was created to contact your fellow human beings. To deny that would be lying. I like to socialize. You like to give me your testimony, and I like to give you mine.

God said it was not good for man to be alone because of the social realm. Adam's spirit communed with God, and that was enough for his spirit, but not for his soul. So God created Eve.

The soul likes fellowship, stories, beauty, testimonies, achievements, and social contact. That is why, when a church has a picnic after communion, the crowd goes up. We are social beings. People sit down and talk, and the stories begin. The soul receives instant gratification in that realm.

He created my soul to make contact with my fellow man, and most of us live there. We live in the soul, not the spirit.

So a pastor can be deceived into simulating success by building a total ministry to the soul while letting the spirit starve to death. My soul can be fed by contact with fellow man, but my spirit cannot. Jesus said:

The words that I speak unto you, they are spirit, and they are life.

The only way I can feed my spirit is through fellowship with God and through the Word of God, which is spirit and life. My spirit was designed to make contact with God. When Adam transgressed and man was separated from God, that contact with God is what he hungered for.

When a pastor begins to simulate success, the crowds come for the picnic. But when you preach on sin, prayer all night for the lost, or responsibility in the kingdom, the crowds go down. When you announce a social event, they come up. The more you minister only in the soul, the more people come flocking in.

I am not excluding socialization. I am advocating it, because that part of your human makeup needs it. To exclude it would be a mistake. But to let the other go is also a mistake.

Pretty soon, every time we gather in what we call church, we only have enough time for what is social. The Word gets fifteen minutes, placed between two good singers so we can hold attention.

Fifteen minutes of Word. Spirit, live on it.

Then we wonder why so many people in our faith churches die when they contract terminal diseases, and why so many businesses fail when the devil singles them out for destruction. They do not know how to face the enemy on any level but the soul realm, and you will not defeat the devil there.

You may know what the Word says, but if you do not have the spiritual stamina and fortification to walk it through, what difference does it make? You do not carry that image. Your emotional breakdown proves it by the way you talk.

Yes, we need socialization. Yes, God wants us sanctified in that area. But the purging you receive in the soul realm is not solid enough to hold you. If you want the kind of purging Jesus gives, you have to take it a step further into the spirit. His fortification and purging will so embrace the soul realm that it will not control you. You will control it.

All permanent change comes from the spiritual realm, not the soul. That is why the baptism of the Holy Ghost took place in my human spirit and not my soul. All permanent purging comes from the spirit, takes over the soul, and manifests in the natural, not the reverse.

When you meditate the Word, you are equipping the Holy Spirit for the purging of the dead limb in your life.

Jesus said:

I am the true vine, and my Father is the husbandman.
Every branch in me that beareth not fruit he taketh away:
And every branch that beareth fruit, he purgeth it, that it may bring forth more fruit.
Now ye are clean through the word which I have spoken unto you.

Then in verse 7:

If ye abide in me, and my words abide in you, ye shall ask what ye will, and it shall be done unto you.

Let us take this purging process one step deeper than the soul. If you want permanent purging, you have to take it a step deeper.

I love to worship God because worship comes forth from my soul. I know what I am doing. My mind, will, intellect, voice, and intelligence join in harmony and cry out, "Father, I love You. I adore You. I glorify You."

I do so in the midst of adversity when the devil is hammering me in the emotional, soul realm. He told me to do so. James said to count it all joy when you fall into diverse temptations, testings, and trials. Paul said we rejoice in tribulations, glory in infirmities, and take pleasure in distresses, perplexities, and persecutions.

In the soul realm where you live in your emotions, nothing will temporarily sustain and fortify you during a trial like worship. The devil has to break you down through your emotions. He has to deceive you into accepting your own defeat.

I do not like to wait for testings and trials. Why wait? They are always there. You are on a planet where there is war. You are always at the beginning, middle, or end of a testing and trial, with sometimes a small space between. You might as well learn how to worship privately before things get bad.

I have found that worship sustains me during a particular test and trial until it is over. But if I want permanent change and permanent peace over the thing that rattled me, I must go a step further into the spirit to receive that kind of purging. This is where praying in tongues comes in.

Go back to John 14:26 and look at the job of the Comforter:

But the Comforter, which is the Holy Ghost, whom the Father will send in my name, he shall teach you all things, and bring all things to your remembrance, whatsoever I have said unto you.

Peace I leave with you, my peace I give unto you: not as the world giveth, give I unto you.

Let not your heart be troubled, neither let it be afraid.

I like that He calls the Holy Spirit the Comforter. The name says it all. He abides in my spirit, so the fortification is of my spirit. His whole ministry is in my spirit. That is why He baptized your spirit, because all permanent change comes from there.

The Father has already sent Him. Jesus said He will teach you all things and bring to your remembrance whatever He has said. There is a way the Holy Spirit gets involved with my human spirit to teach me all things and bring forth the result: "Peace I leave with you, My peace I give unto you."

Peace has nothing to do with tribulations. Jesus said, "In the world you shall have tribulation," but you are the one who must not let your heart be troubled or afraid.

Now you can understand John 15. Jesus says He is the true vine and we are the branches. If we do not abide in Him, we are taken away. If we do, He purges us through the Word He has spoken. He sends the Comforter, the Holy Ghost, who teaches us all things, brings to remembrance what Jesus has said, and brings forth His peace.

The Holy Ghost can purge you to perfect peace regardless of what is going on around you.

Some of you are in difficult situations. The devil is at your doorstep, chewing at your peace. Notice that Jesus said the Comforter will teach you all things. This is the ministry of the Holy Spirit.

If you want permanent peace in that situation, you have to take it further than the soul realm. The soul realm cannot provide it. Worship will fortify the soul realm, and the devil will not quit trying to indoctrinate you, but if you receive purging in the spirit, the Holy Spirit can fortify you from within.

Jesus said in John 16 that the Holy Spirit will take of His and reveal it to you. How does He do that?

Can you think of any religion where God comes and takes up His abode inside you and prays mysteries and revelation knowledge for hours, bringing forth what Jesus is saying? That is tremendous.

When I am praying in tongues, I am speaking mysteries, divine secrets. Those mysteries are not for God's benefit. You are not going to sneak up on God's blind side and whisper a secret in His ear that He did not know before you were born. The mysteries I pray in tongues must be for my benefit.

That means praying in tongues is answered as much as the prayer of faith or any other kind of prayer. The Holy Spirit is fulfilling what Jesus said: He will take of Mine and reveal it unto you.

That supernatural prayer language is part of the process by which He takes from Jesus and reveals it to you. You cannot walk the floor and pray in tongues for hours without some mystery being taken from Christ and revealed to you.

That is what Paul tried to get over to the Corinthians when he called them carnal. The carnal mind does not receive the things of the Spirit of God. When the Holy Ghost has come, He will guide you into all truth. Who knows the things of a man except the spirit of man? Who knows the things of God except the Spirit of God? He has given us the Spirit of God, who knows the deep things of God, to reveal the things of God to us.

He takes of Jesus and reveals it unto us. He teaches us all things.

When your mortification comes from the spiritual realm, the limb dies for good. A social club cannot give you that.

You need to come back and pray. You need to spend time praying in tongues.

Let us stand and worship God.

Father, I am going to tell You how much I love You. I love You.

If you continue in My Word, then are you My disciples indeed. You will know the truth, and the truth will make you free.

There is a place of peace where a person may reside in Me, and it will be evident to the circumstances that order their daily life that they have been set free. Their testimony shall be as one who has been exalted by My hand.

So take My Word and hide it in your heart. Embrace My Holy Spirit and make your stand. I have given you tongues that you may understand My mystery, and those who use them will soon be set free.

I will purge you, saith the Spirit of grace. I will purge you from the things that ought not be, from the things that cause the kingdom disgrace. I will purge you from those things that cause your defeat.

Abide in My Word, and let My Word live in you. I will bring your loved ones in before I am through. The world is looking for reality when they look to you. This will be a city on a hill, a light that cannot be hidden.

Let My Holy Spirit shine forth in you. Walk in the pathways I have dictated, and you will know My peace, for your Father shall see you through.

My God, that is good stuff.